



A PRINTABLE

The Room Reset Checklist

One page per room, in the order that makes the work compound: surfaces before floors, baskets before bins. With a fifteen-minute version for the nights you have nothing left.

Twelve pages · Letter · prints cleanly in black and white

Work in order. Stop when the timer stops.

Each room page is ordered so that what you do first is not undone by what you do next: things back to their homes, then surfaces, then the floor last. Tick as you go; the ticking is half the point.

THREE WAYS TO RUN A RESET

The fifteen-minute reset is the short list on the next page. One room, one timer, nothing else. Most nights this is enough.

The room reset is one room page, start to finish. Twenty to forty minutes depending on the room and the week.

The full reset is every room page in sequence, entry first, laundry last, across a morning. Do it monthly if you can; seasonally if you cannot.

TWO RULES

Nothing new comes into a room during a reset. If you find something that belongs elsewhere, put it by the door and deliver it at the end. And leave one surface in every room completely empty. It is the surface that tells you the room is done.

The fifteen-minute reset

Pick one room. Set a timer. When it rings, you are finished, whether or not the list is.

- ☐ Open a window
- ☐ Gather everything that lives in another room into one basket
- ☐ Return what you can in two minutes; the rest waits by the door
- ☐ Clear and wipe the one surface you look at most
- ☐ Straighten soft things: cushions, throws, the bed
- ☐ Bin out if it is more than half full
- ☐ Floor: the traffic path only, not the corners
- ☐ Deliver the basket. Close the door behind you.

If you have five more minutes, do the corners. If you do not, you still did the reset.

Within arm's reach

A reset is short when nothing has to be fetched. This is the whole kit; it fits in one caddy or one drawer per floor.

☐ Three cloths: one wet, one dry, one for the bathroom

☐ An all-purpose spray you like the smell of

☐ A small brush and pan

☐ Bin liners, folded flat at the bottom of the bin

☐ One basket for things that live elsewhere

☐ A squeegee, if you have shower glass

☐ A microfibre for glass and chrome

☐ This list, on the inside of the cupboard door

WHAT IS NOT ON THE LIST

Specialist products for every surface, a second vacuum, a label maker. Buy those when a reset keeps stalling for want of them, not before.

Entry

The first three seconds of coming home.

- ☐ Clear the drop zone: mail, keys, receipts, the bag that lives there
- ☐ Shoes: pair, and keep only this week's by the door
- ☐ Wipe the console and the mirror
- ☐ Shake or vacuum the mat
- ☐ Coats: one hook each; the rest go back to the closet
- ☐ Sweep or vacuum the floor last

WORTH KNOWING

A tray for keys and a single hook per person do more here than any cabinet.

NOTES

Kitchen

Surfaces first, then the floor. Always.

- ☐ Dishes: run or empty the dishwasher, then clear the sink
- ☐ Counters: everything back to its zone, then wipe
- ☐ Stovetop and the wall behind it
- ☐ Fridge front and handles; one shelf inside
- ☐ Bin out, liner in
- ☐ Sweep, then mop the traffic path only

WORTH KNOWING

If the counters are clear the room reads as clean, whatever the cupboards hold.

NOTES

Living room

The room you look at most; edit before you clean.

- ☐ Return everything that lives in another room
- ☐ Fold throws, plump cushions, square the coffee table
- ☐ Cables: coil and tuck; remotes into one place
- ☐ Dust surfaces top to bottom: shelves, then table, then sills
- ☐ Plants: water, remove dead leaves
- ☐ Vacuum, corners first

WORTH KNOWING

One empty surface per room. Leave it empty.

NOTES

Bedroom

Calm is mostly the absence of small things.

- ☐ Open a window while you work
- ☐ Strip or straighten the bed; fresh pillowcases if not the whole set
- ☐ Clear nightstands to a lamp, a book, and water
- ☐ The chair: clothes to the wardrobe, the hamper, or the wash
- ☐ Dust, then vacuum under the bed edge
- ☐ Close the wardrobe doors

WORTH KNOWING

The nightstand rule: what you touch in the dark, and nothing else.

NOTES

Bathroom

Fast, if you keep the products down.

- ☐ Products: back to the cabinet; keep out only what you use daily
- ☐ Mirror and tap chrome
- ☐ Basin, then toilet, then floor (in that order, one cloth each)
- ☐ Fresh hand towel; hang bath towels to dry
- ☐ Bin out
- ☐ Shower glass squeegee, if you have one; it saves the deep clean

WORTH KNOWING

A tray under the daily bottles keeps the counter one wipe away from done.

NOTES

Workspace

Clear the desk, keep the tools.

- ☐ Paper: file, recycle, or a single action tray
- ☐ Desk surface wiped; monitor and keyboard dusted
- ☐ Cables to one side; chargers to one drawer
- ☐ Pens: test, keep five
- ☐ Return mugs and glasses to the kitchen
- ☐ Chair pushed in when you leave

WORTH KNOWING

A finished desk in the evening is the first fifteen minutes of tomorrow.

NOTES

Kids & multi-use rooms

Zones, not perfection.

- ☐ Everything to its zone: books, blocks, art, soft things
- ☐ One basket per category; lids off so it gets used
- ☐ Rotate: a box of toys away for a month reads as new later
- ☐ Surfaces wiped; walls spot-checked
- ☐ Laundry gathered
- ☐ Vacuum with the small head under furniture

WORTH KNOWING

Label the baskets with pictures for readers-to-be.

NOTES

Laundry & utility

The room that resets the others.

- ☐ Machines: drum wiped, filter checked, door left ajar
- ☐ Fold what is dry; one basket per room, delivered
- ☐ Wipe the top of the machines and the shelf
- ☐ Refill: detergent, cloths, bags
- ☐ Floor swept; the space behind the door too
- ☐ Note anything you ran out of on the restock list

WORTH KNOWING

A single shelf of cloths and refills, visible, keeps every other room's reset short.

NOTES
